QUANTUM IAS & PCS

TATTVA SERIES

UPPSC PRELIMS | FAST REVISION

Ancient History

PYQ-Based Revision Pointers

Chapters 1 to 15

Every pointer comes from an actual UPPSC question · Frequency marks · Year tags
Asked-Most Boxes · Trap Alerts · Quick Tables · Last-Minute 10

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How to Use This Book

Every pointer is a real question. Each pointer is the answer to a UPPSC question asked between 1990 and 2025, written as a fact you can revise in seconds, with the related fact you need for the next variation.

Frequency marks. ■ and a red count (e.g. 4×) mark a fact asked 3 or more times. • and a gold count mark facts asked once or twice. The years follow; "one-liner" means a short starred question in the source with no year given.

Asked Most box. Each chapter opens with the facts UPPSC repeats most. Revise these first.

Diagrams. Flowcharts and diagrams turn sequences (timelines, procedures, processes, river courses) into one picture.

Trap Alerts. The places where the obvious answer is wrong or two facts are commonly swapped.

Last-Minute 10. The ten lines to read on the morning of the exam.

Pairs with the Masterbook. Use this book for revision after the TATTVA PYQ Masterbook, which has the full questions, options and explanations.

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Chapter 1

Stone Age

Built from 26 UPPSC questions (1997–2023). Focus: Foote and the three-age system, Bhimbetka, the Mesolithic sites of the Vindhyas and Pratapgarh, Lahuradewa and Mehrgarh, Burzahom, Chalcolithic and OCP.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- ■ **Mesolithic Ganga plain (Pratapgarh)**: **Mahadaha** bone tools, **Damdama** triple burial, **Lekhahia** most skeletons (Vindhyas) **6×** 2010, 2013, 2016, 2016, 2016, 2021
- ■ **Earliest agriculture**: **Lahuradewa** (UPPSC key, rice); **Mehrgarh** = earliest settled life **6×** 2004, 2007, 2008, 2008, 2008, 2010
- ■ **Domestication of animals** began in the **Mesolithic** (Bagor, Adamgarh); **cereals** in the **Neolithic** **3×** 2005, 2006, 2008
- ■ **Bhimbetka** = prehistoric rock paintings; found by **V.S. Wakankar** **3×** 2011, one-liner, one-liner
- • **Burzahom**: **dog buried with humans**, **pit dwellings** **2×** 2008, one-liner

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

1.1 Discovery of Indian Prehistory

- **Robert Bruce Foote** (first Palaeolithic tool, Pallavaram 1863): a **geologist** and archaeologist (both accepted) **1×** 2015
- Three-age system (stone, bronze, iron), Copenhagen Museum: **Thomsen** ("Thomson") **1×** 2010

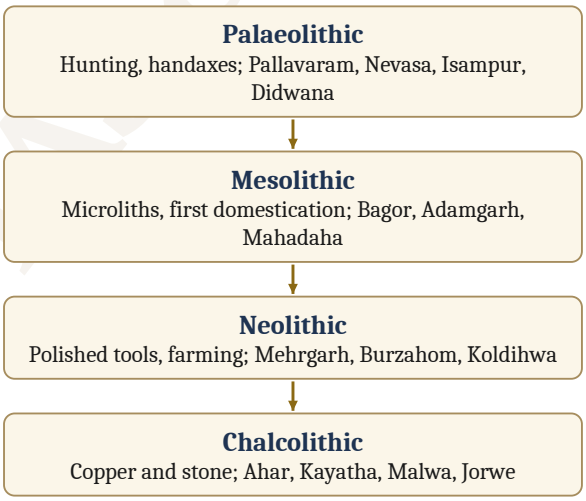
1.2 Palaeolithic Sites and Rock Art

- **Nevasa-Maharashtra, Isampur-Karnataka, Didwana-Rajasthan, Gudiyam cave-Tamil Nadu** **1×** 2023
- Prehistoric paintings: **Bhimbetka** **1×** 2011
- Most rock paintings: **Bhimbetka**; first noticed by **V.S. Wakankar** **2×** one-liner, one-liner

1.3 Mesolithic: Microliths and Domestication

- Domestication of animals began in the **Mesolithic** **1×** 2006
- Mesolithic animal husbandry: **Bagor and Adamgarh** **1×** 2008
- West to east: **Mahadaha, Lekhahia, Paisra, Birbhanpur** **1×** 2021
- Bone implements: **Mahadaha** (and Sarai Nahar Rai) **2×** 2010, 2013
- Three skeletons in one grave: **Damdama** **1×** 2016
- Most human skeletons in a Vindhyan rock shelter: **Lekhahia** **1×** 2016
- Vindhyan people moved to the Ganga valley in a **dry phase** at the end of the Pleistocene (A and R true, R explains A) **1×** 2016

STONE AGE TO METAL



1.4 Neolithic: Farming and Settled Life

- Cereals first cultivated in the **Neolithic Age** **1×** 2005
- First cereal used by man: **barley** **1×** 1997
- ■ Earliest agriculture (key): **Lahuradewa** (rice; date disputed) **4×** 2004, 2007, 2008, 2010
- Earliest settled life: **Mehrgarh** **1×** 2008
- Stone Age to Harappan remains at one site: **Mehrgarh** **1×** 2008
- Dog buried with human: **Burzahom** **1×** 2008
- Pit dwellings: **Burzahom** **1×** one-liner
- Ash mounds: **Sanganakallu** (Karnataka; Budihal also) **1×** 2009

1.5 Chalcolithic, OCP and Megaliths

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- **Navdatoli** excavated by **H.D. Sankalia**; it is in **Madhya Pradesh** 2× 2009, one-liner
- Chalcolithic Maharashtra burials: **north-south** under house floors 1× 1997
- **Ochre-Coloured Pottery** named at **Hastinapur** 1× 2006
- **Megaliths**: **burial sites** 1× 2005

Site	Known for
Pallavaram (TN)	First Palaeolithic tool (Foote, 1863)
Bhimbetka (MP)	Rock paintings
Bagor, Adamgarh	Earliest animal domestication
Mahadaha, Damdama, Sarai Nahar Rai (UP)	Mesolithic burials, bone tools
Lahuradewa (UP)	Early rice (UPPSC key)
Mehrgarh (Pakistan)	Earliest settled farming village
Burzahom (Kashmir)	Pit dwellings, dog burials
Koldihwa (UP)	Neolithic rice
Hastinapur (UP)	OCP named

TRAP ALERT

- Animals were domesticated in the **Mesolithic**; cereals came in the **Neolithic**.
- Earliest rice in UPPSC keys = **Lahuradewa**; earliest settled village = **Mehrgarh**.
- **Mahadaha** = double burials; **Damdama** = triple burial.
- Megaliths are **burials**, not temples.

UP LINK

UP link: UP is rich in Mesolithic sites: **Sarai Nahar Rai, Mahadaha, Damdama** (Pratapgarh), **Lekhahia** and **Baghor** in the Vindhyas (Mirzapur-Sonbhadra), **Koldihwa** (Prayagraj, Neolithic rice), **Lahuradewa** (Sant Kabir Nagar) and **Hastinapur** (Meerut, OCP).

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Foote = father of Indian prehistory (Pallavaram 1863)
2. Thomsen = three-age system
3. Bhimbetka paintings; Wakankar found them
4. Domestication: Mesolithic (Bagor, Adamgarh)
5. Mahadaha bone tools; Damdama triple burial; Lekhahia most skeletons
6. Barley = first cereal; cereals in Neolithic
7. Lahuradewa = earliest rice (key); Mehrgarh = earliest settled life
8. Burzahom = dog burial, pit houses
9. Navdatoli = Sankalia (MP); OCP = Hastinapur
10. Megaliths = burial sites

Chapter 2

Indus Valley Civilization

Built from 48 UPPSC questions (1990–2023). Focus: excavators and sites, site-river and site-state matching, UP's Harappan sites, Lothal, Kalibangan and Dholavira, seals and religion.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Site-state matching**: **Kalibangan-Rajasthan, Rakhigarhi-Haryana, Manda-J&K, Daimabad-Maharashtra, Hulas and Alamgirpur-UP, Lothal and Dholavira-Gujarat** 7× 1996, 2006, 2010, 2012, 2018, 2020, 2021
- **Site-river matching**: **Harappa-Ravi, Kalibangan-Ghaggar, Lothal-Bhogava, Ropar-Sutlej** 3× 2008, 2010, one-liner
- **Lothal** = port and dockyard, ivory scale; **Kalibangan** = ploughed field; **Dholavira** = three-part city, water management 9× 1995, 2005, 2006, 2010, 2010, 2013, 2014, one-liner, one-liner
- **Great Bath** = **Mohenjo-daro** 2× 1992, 2010
- Harappan source: **archaeological excavations**; a **proto-historic** culture 4× 1993, 1994, 1996, 1996

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

2.1 Nature and Sources

- Indus civilisation: **proto-historic** age (script not read) **1×** 1996
- Source of knowledge: **archaeological excavations** **3×** 1993, 1994, 1996
- Mohenjo-daro and Harappa are dead cities; being excavated is not the reason (A and R true, R does not explain A) **1×** 2009
- Human society depends mainly on **economy** (per key) **1×** 2004
- Non-Aryan because it was **urban** **1×** 2010
- Placed before the Aryans because of its **pottery** **1×** 1990
- Different from the Vedic culture: **all of the above** **1×** 2004

2.2 Discovery and Excavators

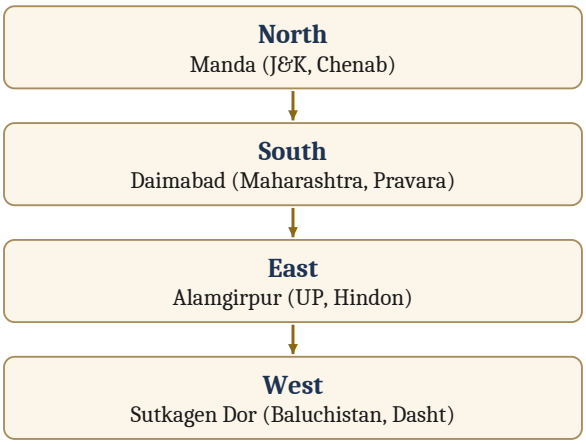
- First to dig Harappa without seeing its value: **Alexander Cunningham** **1×** 2006
- **Harappa-Daya Ram Sahni, Hastinapur-B.B. Lal, Takshashila-John Marshall, Kaushambi-N.G. Majumdar** (per key) **1×** 2017
- Wrong pair: **Dholavira-B.K. Thapar** (Dholavira = R.S. Bisht, found by J.P. Joshi) **1×** 2006
- **Chanhudaro** excavated by **J.H. Mackay** **1×** 2015

Site	Excavator
Harappa	Daya Ram Sahni (1921)
Mohenjo-daro	R.D. Banerji (1922)
Chanhudaro	N.G. Majumdar, J.H. Mackay
Lothal	S.R. Rao
Kalibangan	B.B. Lal, B.K. Thapar
Dholavira	R.S. Bisht
Rakhigarhi	Amarendra Nath, Vasant Shinde

2.3 Extent and Site Locations

- Eastern boundary: **Alamgirpur** (Meerut, on the Hindon) **1×** 2023
- **Manda-J&K, Daimabad-Maharashtra, Kalibangan-Rajasthan, Rakhigarhi-Haryana** **1×** 2012
- Rivers of the civilisation: **Sindhu, Chenab, Jhelum** (1, 2, 3); not Ganga **1×** 2009
- **Harappa-Ravi, Hastinapur-Ganga, Nagarjunakonda-Krishna, Paithan-Godavari** **1×** 2008
- **Harappa-Ravi, Kalibangan-Ghaggar, Lothal-Bhogava, Ropar-Sutlej** **1×** 2010
- Wrong pair: **Kalibangan-Haryana** (it is Rajasthan) **1×** 1996
- Wrong pair: **Rakhigarhi-Rajasthan** (it is Haryana) **1×** 2006
- **Balu-Haryana, Manda-J&K, Padri-Gujarat, Hulas-UP** **1×** 2020
- In Sindh: **Mohenjo-daro and Chanhudaro** (2 and 3) **1×** 2010
- Now in Pakistan: **Harappa** (Punjab province) **1×** 1994
- Largest Harappan site in India: **Rakhigarhi** **1×** 2004
- In UP: **Alamgirpur and Hulas** (III and IV) **1×** 2018
- **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar): **UP** **1×** 2021
- **Dadheri**: late Harappan site in **Punjab** **1×** 2014
- **Sinauli** (Baghpat): **human burials** **1×** 2004

HARAPPAN FRONTIER SITES



2.4 Cities, Buildings and Crafts

- **Great Bath**: **Mohenjo-daro** **2×** 1992, 2010
- **Harappa-Cemetery R-37, Lothal-dockyard, Kalibangan-furrowed land, Mohenjo-daro-dancing girl** **1×** 2017
- House wells: several sites (*); best answer **Mohenjo-daro** **1×** 2004
- In India: **Lothal** **1×** 1995
- **Lothal**: on the **Bhogava**, in **Gujarat**; the **port town** **3×** one-liner, one-liner, one-liner

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- Ivory scale: **Lothal** 1× 2014
- Boat models: **Mohenjo-daro and Lothal** 1× 2022
- Ploughed field: **Kalibangan** 1× 2005
- Double burial: **Lothal** (and Kalibangan) 1× 2016
- Rock-cut (reservoir) architecture: **Dholavira** 1× 2006

■ **Dholavira**: **Gujarat**; city in **three parts**; advanced **water management** 3× 2010, 2010, 2013

Site	Famous for
Mohenjo-daro	Great Bath, granary, dancing girl, Pashupati seal
Harappa	Granaries, Cemetery R-37
Lothal	Dockyard, rice husk, ivory scale, double burial
Kalibangan	Ploughed field, fire altars, horned deity cake
Dholavira	Three-part city, reservoirs, signboard
Chanhudaro	Bead factory; no citadel
Banawali	Barley, toy plough

2.5 Economy, Religion and Contemporaries

- Not true: Harappans **knew iron** 1× 1992
- Cotton for cloth first grown in **India** 1× 2006
- Not on Harappan seals: **horse** 1× 2009
- Idol worship began in **pre-Aryan** times 1× 1992
- Horned deity on a terracotta cake: **Kalibangan** 1× 2008
- On the Nile: **Egyptian** civilisation 1× 2004
- North to south: **Aztec, Maya, Muisca, Inca** 1× 2016

TRAP ALERT

- Kalibangan = **Rajasthan** (Ghaggar); Rakhigarhi = **Haryana**; Harappa = Pakistan's **Punjab**, not Sindh.
- Lothal is on the **Bhogava**, not the Sabarmati.
- No iron, no horse on seals, no temples; but figurines show image worship.
- Alamgirpur is on the **Hindon**, not the Ganga.

UP LINK

UP link: UP's Harappan and late Harappan sites are **Alamgirpur** (Meerut, eastern limit), **Hulas** (Saharanpur), **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar, gold hoard) and **Sinauli** (Baghpat, burials with copper objects and "chariots").

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Proto-historic; known from excavations
2. Cunningham first; Daya Ram Sahni dug Harappa
3. Kalibangan = Rajasthan (Ghaggar); Rakhigarhi = Haryana (largest in India)
4. Harappa = Ravi; Ropar = Sutlej; Lothal = Bhogava
5. Alamgirpur, Hulas, Mandi, Sinauli = UP
6. Great Bath = Mohenjo-daro
7. Lothal = dockyard, ivory scale; Kalibangan = ploughed field
8. Dholavira = three parts, water system (Bisht)
9. No iron; no horse on seals; cotton first in India
10. Idol worship began before the Aryans

Chapter 3

Vedic Age

Built from 56 UPPSC questions (1991–2023). Focus: the term Arya, Boghazkoi, Rig Vedic rivers, the four Vedas and their layers, Upanishads, assemblies, cattle economy, Indra and Agni, the Later Vedic shift.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Satyameva Jayate** from the **Mundaka Upanishad** 4× 1991, 2004, 2004, 2014
- **Upanishads** = **philosophy** and **moksha**; Nachiketa-Yama in the **Katha** Upanishad 6× 1998, 1999, 2002, 2002, 2003, 2004
- **Aghanya** = **cow**; cow = most valuable property; **yava** = barley 5× 2008, 2008, 2010, 2015, 2017
- **Indra** = most hymns (about 250), war god, thunder and rain; **Agni** next 5× 2002, 2010, 2011, 2017, one-liner
- **Rivers**: **Asikni-Chenab, Parushni-Ravi, Shutudri-Sutlej, Kubha-Kabul, Sadanira-Gandak**; Saraswati = "Naditama" 5× 2008, 2010, 2010, 2012, one-liner

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

3.1 The Aryans and Their Home

- "Aryan" denotes a **speech group** (key: noble; never a race) 1× 1999
- Classical meaning of "Arya": a **noble man** 1× 1998
- Wrote on the Aryans' original home (Arctic): **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** 1× 1996
- **Boghazkoi** (Turkey, 14th century BCE): inscription naming **Vedic gods** 3× 1996, one-liner, one-liner
- Avesta resembles the Rig Veda; it is from **Iran** 1× 2004

3.2 Rig Vedic Geography and Tribes

- **Asikni** = **Chenab** 1× 2010
- Rivers linking the Aryans with Afghanistan: **Kubha, Kramu** 1× 2010
- **Kubha** is in **Afghanistan** (Kabul river) 1× one-liner
- **Kubha-Kabul, Parushni-Ravi, Sadanira-Gandak, Shutudri-Sutlej** 1× 2012
- "Matetama, Devitama, Naditama": **Saraswati** 1× 2008
- Not in the Panchajana: **Kikata** 1× 2009
- **Battle of Ten Kings**: on the **Parushni** (Ravi); Sudas won with Vasishtha 1× 2008

Vedic name	Modern river
Sindhu	Indus
Vitasta	Jhelum
Asikni	Chenab
Parushni	Ravi
Vipas	Beas
Shutudri	Sutlej
Kubha	Kabul
Gomati	Gomal
Sadanira	Gandak

3.3 The Four Vedas and Their Layers

- Oldest Veda: **Rig Veda** (a collection of **hymns**) 2× 1995, one-liner
- **Trayi**: the **three Vedas** (Rig, Sama, Yajur) 1× 2010
- **Rig-hymns and prayers, Yajur-hymns and rituals, Sama-musical hymns, Atharva-charms and spells** 2× 2002, 2003
- Compiled from the Rig Veda: **Samaveda** 1× 1997
- **Ayurveda** first appears in the **Atharvaveda** 1× 1994
- Rig Veda's "basic script" (key): **Brahmi** (it was oral) 1× 2004
- **Hota** priest: **Rig Veda** 1× one-liner
- **Gayatri Mantra**: **Rig Veda** (3rd Mandala, Vishvamitra) 1× 2013
- Order: **Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads** 1× 2014
- **Gopatha Brahmana**: **Atharvaveda** 1× 2014
- 800-600 BCE: the **Brahmana** era 1× 2002

Veda	Content	Priest	Upaveda
Rig	Hymns and prayers	Hota	Ayurveda (often)
Yajur	Rituals (prose)	Adhvaryu	Dhanurveda
Sama	Melodies	Udgata	Gandharvaveda
Atharva	Charms, medicine	Brahma	Shilpaveda (Ayurveda first appears here)

3.4 Upanishads

- Upanishads: **philosophy** 3× 1998, 2002, 2004

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- Talks of **moksha**: **Upanishads** 1× 2003
- **Nachiketa and Yama**: **Katha Upanishad** 2× 1999, 2002
- **Satyameva Jayate**: **Mundaka Upanishad** 4× 1991, 2004, 2004, 2014
- King **Ashvapati** ruled **Kekaya** 1× 1999

3.5 Polity, Economy and Society

- **Sabha and Samiti** as daughters of Prajapati: **Atharvaveda** 1× 2009
- **Bhagadugha**: **revenue collector** 1× 2023
- Aryans' chief livelihood (key): **agriculture** (Rig Vedic life was mainly pastoral) 1× 1993
- **Yava** = **barley** 1× 2008
- Most valuable early Rig Vedic property: **cow** 1× 2015
- **Aghanya** = **cows** (not to be killed) 3× 2008, 2010, 2017
- **Nishka**: a **neck** ornament 2× 2005, 2007
- **Indus-urban, Rig Vedic-pastoral, Later Vedic-agrarian, medieval-landlordism** 1× 2020
- **Gotra** first appears in the **Rig Veda** 1× 2005

3.6 Rig Vedic Religion

- People believed mainly in **sacrifice and rituals** 1× 1993
- Rig Vedic religion: **polytheistic** 1× 2014
- Most hymns: **Indra** (2010 key: Agni) 2× 2002, 2010
- War god and most popular deity: **Indra** 2× 2011, one-liner
- Indra: god of **thunder and rain** (1 and 4); Varuna guards moral order 1× 2017
- Priest of the gods: **Brihaspati** 1× 2013

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC

Rig Vedic (1500-1000 BCE)
Sapta Sindhu; pastoral; tribal; Indra, Agni

↓

Later Vedic (1000-600 BCE)
Ganga-Yamuna doab; Kuru-Panchala heartland

↓

Economy
Agriculture, iron (PGW), settled villages

↓

Society
Varna hardens; women's status declines

↓

Religion
Prajapati, Vishnu, Rudra rise; rituals grow

3.7 Later Vedic Age, Puranas and Epics

- Axis of Later Vedic culture: **Kuru-Panchala** 1× 2007
- Earliest iron (classic key): **Atranjikhera** 1× 1998
- Videgha Mathava's priest: **Gautama Rahugana** 1× 2015
- **Purushamedha**: in several texts (*) 1× 2008
- Sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantara, vamshanucharita: **Puranas** 1× 2015
- Number of Puranas: **18** 2× 2009, 2010
- Mahabharata's original name: **Jaya Samhita**; also "**Shatasahasri Samhita**" 2× 2014, one-liner

TRAP ALERT

- **Asikni = Chenab**; **Parushni = Ravi** (students swap them).
- Gayatri = **Rig Veda**, 3rd Mandala; Satyameva Jayate = **Mundaka**, not Mandukya.
- Ayurveda first in the **Atharvaveda**; Samaveda is drawn from the Rig Veda.
- Sabha and Samiti = Prajapati's daughters in the **Atharvaveda**.

UP LINK

UP link: the Later Vedic heartland, **Kuru-Panchala**, lay largely in western UP (**Hastinapur, Ahichchhatra, Kampilya**); **Atranjikhera** (Etah) gave early iron with Painted Grey Ware, and **Naimisharanya** (Sitapur) is linked with the telling of the Puranas.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Arya = speech group (no race); Tilak = Arctic home
2. Boghazkoi = Vedic gods, 14th century BCE
3. Asikni = Chenab; Parushni = Ravi (Ten Kings); Kubha = Kabul
4. Saraswati = Naditama; Rig Veda oldest
5. Gayatri = Rig Veda; Ayurveda = Atharvaveda
6. Samhita, Brahmana, Aranyaka, Upanishad
7. Satyameva Jayate = Mundaka; Nachiketa = Katha
8. Aghanya = cow; yava = barley; nishka = neck ornament
9. Indra = most hymns; Brihaspati = gods' priest
10. Kuru-Panchala = Later Vedic axis; 18 Puranas; Jaya Samhita

Chapter 4

Buddhism

Built from 66 UPPSC questions (1991–2023). Focus: Buddha's life and the UP circuit, symbols, doctrine, Triratna, the Tripitaka, the four councils, sects, stupas, chaityas and art schools.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

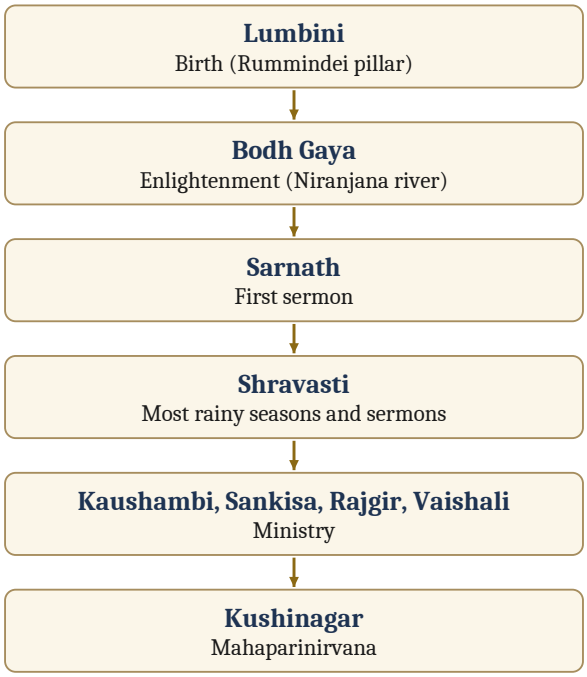
- **Kushinagar**: **Mahaparinirvana**, capital of the **Mallas** 5× 2004, 2005, 2011, 2015, one-liner
- **Sarnath**: first sermon (**Dharmachakrapravartana**); deer and wheel symbol 5× 2002, 2004, 2015, one-liner, one-liner
- **Lumbini** birthplace, proved by Ashoka's **Rummindei** pillar (Mauryan) 7× 2004, 2006, 2007, 2011, one-liner, one-liner, one-liner
- **Councils**: **Rajgriha** (Ajatashatru, Mahakashyapa), **Vaishali** (Kalashoka), **Pataliputra** (Ashoka), **Kundalavana** (Kanishka) 9× 2000, 2002, 2010, 2015, one-liner, one-liner, one-liner, one-liner, one-liner
- **Sanchi** = best stupa, not linked with any event of Buddha's life; built by **Ashoka** 4× 2008, 2008, 2011, one-liner

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

4.1 Life of the Buddha

- **Mahabhinishkramana**: his **departure from home** 1× 2014
- Mother's clan: **Koliya** 1× one-liner
- Born at **Lumbini** 1× one-liner
- Lumbini proven by **Mauryan** inscriptions: Ashoka's **Rummindei pillar**, marking the **birth** 6× 2004, 2006, 2007, 2011, one-liner, one-liner
- **Alara Kalama**: Buddha's **teacher** 1× 2010
- On the **Niranjana**: **Bodh Gaya** 1× 2012
- First sermon: **Sarnath** (Dharmachakrapravartana) 4× 2004, 2015, one-liner, one-liner
- Born in Kapilavastu (home town), enlightened at Bodh Gaya, rejected the Vedas, preached noble truths (all four per key) 1× 2010
- Wheel with deer: **first sermon** 1× 2002
- **Birth-lotus, first sermon-wheel, enlightenment-Bodhi tree, great departure-horse** 1× 2005
- Most sermons: **Shravasti** 1× 2011
- Visited Kaushambi under **Udayana** 1× 2010
- **Mahaparinirvana**: **Kushinagar** (Malla republic) 3× 2005, 2011, one-liner
- Kushinagar was the Malla capital; the parinirvana there does not explain that (A and R true, R does not explain A) 1× 2004
- **Mahaparinirvana Temple**: **Kushinagar** 1× 2015
- Last disciple: **Subhadda** 2× 2013, 2016
- Last rainy season: **Vaishali** 1× 2015

EIGHT GREAT PLACES



4.2 Doctrine and the Sangha

- Noble truths in order: **suffering, its cause, its cessation, the path** 1× 2006
- Buddha's teachings: **purity of conduct** 1× 1991
- "World is unstable and transient": **Buddhism** 1× 1992
- Buddha on karma, rebirth, nirvana and God: no option accepted (*) 1× 1992
- Buddhism **accepts rebirth**; the "no soul" idea is true (A false, R true) 1× 2006
- Jainism and Buddhism both accept **karma and transmigration** 1× 1996
- **Triratna**: **Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha** 1× 2017
- Wanted to lead the Sangha: **Devadatta** 1× 1999
- Women admitted as nuns at **Vaishali** 1× 2010

4.3 Texts

- **Tripitaka**: collection of Buddha's **teachings** 2× 2003, 2004
- Monastic rules: **Vinaya Pitaka** 1× one-liner
- **Vinaya-monastic rules, Sutta-teachings, Abhidhamma-philosophy, Mahavamsa-regional history** 1× 2023
- **Milindapanha**: Menander and **Nagasena** 1× 2023
- "Light of Asia": **Gautama Buddha**; Edwin Arnold's book draws on the **Lalitavistara** 2× 2010, 2014

4.4 The Four Councils

- First council presided by **Mahakashyapa**, under **Ajatashatru**, at **Rajgir** (Saptaparni cave) 5× 2000, 2010, one-liner, one-liner, one-liner
- Order: **Rajgriha, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kundalavana** 1× 2002
- Second council: **Vaishali**; fourth under **Kanishka** 2× one-liner, one-liner
- Third council (Ashoka) in the **Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa** 1× 1999
- **Ashokarama** monastery: **Pataliputra** 1× 2015

Council	Place	Patron	President
First	Rajgriha (Saptaparni)	Ajatashatru	Mahakashyapa
Second	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Sabakami
Third	Pataliputra	Ashoka	Moggaliputta Tissa
Fourth	Kundalavana (Kashmir)	Kanishka	Vasumitra

4.5 Sects, Spread and Decline

- Hinayana vs Mahayana: **worship of god and goddess** (images, Bodhisattvas) 1× 1996
- **Shunyata** (void): **Nagarjuna** 1× 1998
- Karmapa Lama: **Kagyupa** sect 1× 2000
- Buddhism kept caste, challenged Brahmins and called some jobs low (1, 2, 3) 1× 1998
- Spread by simplicity, appeal to the lowly, missionary zeal, local language (1, 2, 3, 4) 1× 2009

4.6 Stupas, Caves and Art

- Not linked with Buddha's life: **Sanchi** 2× 2008, 2011
- Sarnath pillar: **Ashoka** 1× 2008
- **Kaushambi-Ghositarama, Kushinagar-Ramabhar stupa, Sarnath-Dhamekh, Shravasti-Sahet-Mahet** 1× 2010
- Stupa chronology: no option accepted (*) 1× 2014
- **Amaravati** stupa: **Satavahanas** 1× 2023
- Best stupa: **Sanchi**, built by **Ashoka** 2× 2008, one-liner

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

- Largest stupa: **Kesariya** (Bihar) 1× 2023
- **Chaitya** = worship hall; **vihara** = dwelling 1× 2001
- Largest Hinayana chaitya: **Karle** 1× 2014
- Eleven-headed Bodhisattva: **Kanheri** 1× 2017
- **Valabhi** university: **Gujarat** 1× 2014
- Laid the base of idol worship (key): **Buddhism** 1× 2008
- Standing Buddha statue: **Kushana** period 1× 1992
- Sarnath Bhumisparsha Buddha: **Gupta** period 3× 2009, 2010, 2010

TRAP ALERT

- Most sermons = **Shravasti**; last rainy season = **Vaishali**; death = **Kushinagar**.
- Buddhist Triratna = Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha; Jain Triratna = right faith, knowledge, conduct.
- Sanchi is **not** connected with any event of Buddha's life.
- Amaravati = **Satavahana**, not Mauryan; Kesariya is the largest stupa.

UP LINK

UP link: four of the eight great places are in UP: **Sarnath** (Dhamekh stupa), **Shravasti** (Sahet-Mahet, Jetavana), **Kushinagar** (Mahaparinirvana temple, Ramabhar stupa) and **Sankisa**; **Kaushambi** has the Ghositarama monastery, and **Piprahwa** (Siddharthnagar) is identified with Kapilavastu.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Mahabhinishkramana = leaving home; mother = Koliya
2. Lumbini = birth (Rummindei pillar)
3. Bodh Gaya on the Niranjana; Sarnath = first sermon
4. Shravasti = most sermons; Kushinagar = Malla, parinirvana
5. Subhadda = last disciple; Vaishali = last rainy season, nuns admitted
6. Triratna = Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha; Devadatta = rival
7. Councils: Rajgriha, Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kundalavana
8. Nagasena + Milinda; Nagarjuna = shunyata
9. Sanchi = Ashoka; Amaravati = Satavahana; Kesariya = largest
10. Karle = biggest chaitya; Sarnath Buddha = Gupta

Chapter 5

Jain Religion

Built from 25 UPPSC questions (1993–2023). Focus: Tirthankaras and their symbols, Parshvanatha, UP's Jain sites, Mahavira's life, Triratna, councils, sects and the Ajivikas.

QUANTUM

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Rishabhadeva** (Adinatha) founded Jainism; **Mahavira** is the 24th Tirthankara **3×** 1993, 2004, 2010
- **Parshvanatha** (23rd): **Varanasi**; nirvana at **Sammed Shikhar** **3×** 2002, 2002, 2016
- **Tirthankara-symbol and UP site matching**: **Adinatha-bull, Parshvanatha-snake, Mallinatha-water jar, Sambhavnath-horse; Shravasti-Sambhavnath, Ayodhya-Rishabhanath, Kakandi-Suvidhinath, Pabhosa-Padmaprabhu** **3×** 2017, 2021, 2021
- **Triratna** (right faith, knowledge, conduct) is the glory of **Jainism**; core point **non-violence** **2×** 1993, 2004
- **Ajivika** sect: **Makkhali Gosala**; "fate decides everything" **4×** 1996, 2006, 2017, 2023

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

5.1 Tirthankaras

- Originator of Jainism: **Rishabhadeva** **1×** 2010
- "Tirthankara": **Jainism** **1×** 1993
- Not a Tirthankara: **Nathamuni** (a Vaishnava acharya) **1×** 2004
- Order: **Abhinandan, Padmaprabhu, Vimalnath, Munisuvrata** **1×** 2016
- **Parshvanatha**: **Varanasi** **1×** 2016
- Parshvanatha's pilgrimage: **Sammed Shikhar** (Jharkhand) **2×** 2002, 2002
- **Adinatha-bull, Mallinatha-water jar, Parshvanatha-snake, Sambhavnath-horse** **1×** 2017
- Wrong pair: **Vasupujya-Sammed Shikhar** (Vasupujya attained nirvana at **Champa**) **1×** 2021

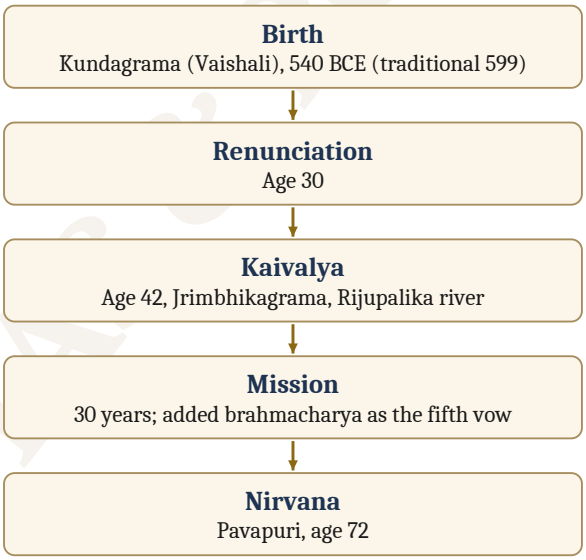
5.2 UP in Jain Geography

- **Shravasti-Sambhavnath, Kakandi-Suvidhinath, Ayodhya-Rishabhanath, Pabhosa-Padmaprabhu** **1×** 2021
- **Prabhasgiri** (Pabhosa): a **Jain** pilgrimage **1×** 2008
- Pilgrimage of both Buddhists and Jains in UP: **Kaushambi** **1×** 2010

5.3 Mahavira and Doctrine

- **Kundalpur**: birthplace of **Mahavira** **1×** 2004
- Enlightenment on the **Rijupalika** river **1×** 2017
- First follower (son-in-law): **Jamali** **1×** 2008
- **Triratna** (right faith, action, knowledge): **Jainism** **1×** 2004
- Basic point: **non-violence** **1×** 1993
- No "final annihilation of the world": **Jainism** **1×** 2014

MAHAVIRA'S LIFE



5.4 Literature, Councils and Sects

- Earliest Jain texts: **Ardha-Magadhi** **1×** 2006
- Shvetambara Agamas finally edited at **Valabhi** (key: Pataliputra) **1×** 2008
- **Yapaniya**: a **Jain** sect **1×** 2010
- **Ajivika** founder: **Makkhali Gosala** **1×** 1996
- "Fate assigns everything": **Ajivikas** **1×** 2006
- Ajivikas respected in the Maurya era (only II); they were not forest dwellers **1×** 2023
- **Lakulisha-Pashupata, Nagarjuna-Shunyavada, Bhadrabahu-Jainism, Gosala-Ajivika** **1×** 2017
- **Gommateshwara** (Shravanabelagola) built by **Chamundaraya** **1×** 2009

Council	Place	Head	Result
First	Pataliputra (c. 300 BCE)	Sthulabhadra	12 Angas compiled; split begins

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

Council	Place	Head	Result
Second	Valabhi (5th century CE)	Devardhi Kshamashramana	Agamas finally written

TRAP ALERT

- Mahavira is the **24th**, not the first; Rishabhadeva founded Jainism.
- Jain Triratna = right faith, knowledge, conduct; Buddhist = Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha.
- Parshvanatha gave **four** vows; Mahavira added **brahmacharya**.
- Ajivika = Gosala; Pashupata = Lakulisha; Yapaniya = Jain.

UP LINK

UP link: UP holds the birthplaces of many Tirthankaras: **Ayodhya** (Rishabhanatha and four others), **Shravasti** (Sambhavnath), **Kaushambi/Pabhosa** (Padmaprabhu), **Varanasi** (Parshvanatha, Suparshvanatha), **Kakandi** (Suvidhinath) and **Hastinapur**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Rishabhadeva = founder; Mahavira = 24th
2. Parshvanatha = Varanasi; Sammed Shikhar
3. Adinatha = bull; Parshvanatha = snake; Mallinatha = water jar
4. Shravasti = Sambhavnath; Ayodhya = Rishabhanath
5. Kaushambi = Buddhist and Jain site; Pabhosa = Jain
6. Kundalpur birth; Rijupalika enlightenment; Jamali first follower
7. Triratna = Jainism; non-violence = core
8. Ardha-Magadhi texts; Valabhi = final edit
9. Yapaniya = Jain; Ajivika = Gosala
10. Gommateshwara = Chamundaraya

Chapter 6

Shaiva and Bhagavata Religion

Built from 16 UPPSC questions (1997–2022). Focus: iconography, Alvars and Nayanars, Heliodorus and the Bhagavatas, avatars of Vishnu, astika and nastika, the Gita and sacred geography.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Nayanars** = **Shaiva** saints; **Alvars** = Vaishnava **3×** 2006, 2013, 2014
- **Heliodorus** pillar (**Besnagar**) = earliest evidence of Bhagavatism; Heliodorus came from **Taxila** **3×** 1997, 2008, 2010
- **Gita** gives equal weight to **jnana, karma, bhakti**; the Bhagavata Purana is **not** in the Prasthanatrayi **2×** 1997, 2005

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

6.1 Iconography and Shaivism

- **Shiva-trident, Vishnu-chakra, Ganesha-noose, Saraswati-veena** **1×** 2022
- **Ardhanarishvara**: union of god with his **Shakti** **1×** 1997

6.2 Tamil Bhakti

- **Nayanars**: **Shaiva** saints **2×** 2006, 2014
- Not an Alvar: **Tirugyan** (Tirujnana Sambandar is a Nayanar) **1×** 2013

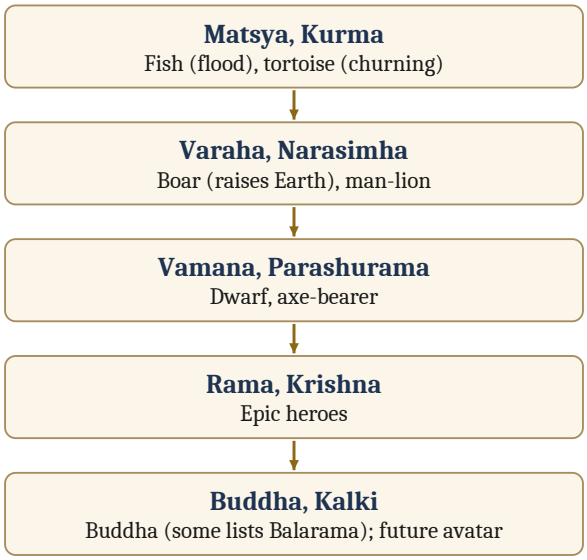
Group	God	Famous names
Alvars (12)	Vishnu	Andal (woman), Nammalvar, Periyalvar
Nayanars (63)	Shiva	Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, Manikkavachakar

6.3 Bhagavatism and Vishnu

- First worshippers of Vasudeva Krishna: **Bhagavatas** **1×** 1997
- Earliest record of Bhagavatism: **Heliodorus' Besnagar inscription** **1×** 2008
- Heliodorus was from **Taxila** **1×** 2010

- Deity holding a plough: **Balarama** 1× 2007
- Avatar that saved the Earth from the sea: **Varaha** 1× 2010
- Forms of bhakti (Bhagavata): **9** 1× 2010

TEN AVATARS OF VISHNU



6.4 Philosophy, Epics and Sacred Places

- Astika vs nastika: belief in the **Vedas' authority** 1× 2005
- Equal place to jnana, karma, bhakti: **Bhagavad Gita** 1× 2005
- Not in the Prasthanatrayi: **Bhagavata** (it is Upanishads, Gita, Brahma Sutra) 1× 1997
- Mahabharata told to 60,000 hermits at **Naimisharanya** 1× 2006
- Rama meets Hanuman in the **Kishkindha Kanda** 1× 2004
- Nashik Kumbh: on the **Godavari** 1× 2003

TRAP ALERT

- Alvars = Vishnu; Nayanars = Shiva.
- Heliodorus was an Indo-Greek envoy from **Taxila** (of Antialkidas), not Megasthenes.
- Gita is in the Prasthanatrayi; the Bhagavata Purana is not.
- Varaha raises the Earth; Matsya saves Manu in the flood.

UP LINK

UP link: **Naimisharanya** (Sitapur) is where the Mahabharata and Puranas were recited; **Mathura** is the centre of Bhagavata worship of Vasudeva Krishna, and **Prayagraj** hosts the Kumbh at the Sangam.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Shiva = trident; Vishnu = chakra; Saraswati = veena
2. Ardhanarishvara = god + Shakti
3. Nayanars = Shaiva; Alvars = Vaishnava
4. Bhagavatas first worshipped Vasudeva Krishna
5. Heliodorus (Taxila) = Besnagar pillar
6. Balarama holds the plough; Varaha saves the Earth
7. Nine forms of bhakti
8. Astika = accepts the Vedas
9. Gita = jnana, karma, bhakti
10. Naimisharanya = Mahabharata recital; Nashik Kumbh = Godavari

Chapter 7

Sixth Century BCE: Political Condition

Built from 25 UPPSC questions (1992–2021). Focus: the sixteen Mahajanapadas and their capitals, UP's Mahajanapadas, kings of the Buddha's age, Haryanka, Shishunaga and Nanda Magadha, punch-marked coins.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Mahajanapada-capital matching**: **Kuru-Indraprastha, Panchala-Ahichhatra, Kosala-Shravasti/Saketa, Vatsa-Kaushambi, Surasena-Mathura, Chedi-Suktimati, Anga-Champa, Matsya-Viratnagar, Asmaka-Potana** 7× 2008, 2011, 2014, 2016, 2017, 2020, one-liner
- Sixteen Mahajanapadas listed in the **Anguttara Nikaya**; **8** lay in today's UP 4× 2004, 2008, 2008, 2021
- **Ajatashatru** killed his father Bimbisara and was killed by his son 2× 2007, 2011
- **Mahapadma Nanda** = "Aparo Parashurama"; Nanda is named in **Kharavela's Hathigumpha** inscription 3× 1999, 2010, 2010
- Earliest Indian coins: **silver punch-marked** 1× 2010

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

7.1 The Sixteen Mahajanapadas

- Listed in the **Anguttara Nikaya** 3× 2004, 2008, 2008
- Mahajanapadas in present UP: **8** 1× 2021
- **Kuru-Indraprastha, Panchala-Ahichhatra, Kosala-Saketa, Vatsa-Kaushambi** 1× 2008
- Wrong pair: **Kosala-Ahichhatra** 1× 2017
- Capital of North Panchala: **Ahichhatra** 1× 2006
- Wrong pair: **Surasena-Kaushambi** (Surasena = **Mathura**) 1× 2016
- **Suktimati**: capital of **Chedi** 1× 2011
- Ancient Shravasti: **crescent-shaped** town 1× 2010
- **Kalpi** stands on the **Yamuna** 1× 2015
- **Champa**: capital of **Anga** 1× 2014
- **Matsya**: **Rajasthan** 1× 2017
- **Matsya-Viratnagar, Kuru-Indraprastha, Surasena-Mathura, Asmaka-Potana** 1× 2020
- Ujjain's old name: **Avantika** 1× 2009

Mahajanapada	Capital	Today
Kashi	Varanasi	UP
Kosala	Shravasti, Saketa	UP
Vatsa	Kaushambi	UP
Panchala	Ahichhatra, Kampilya	UP
Surasena	Mathura	UP
Kuru	Indraprastha	Delhi-Haryana-west UP
Malla	Kushinara, Pava	UP
Chedi	Suktimati	Bundelkhand
Magadha	Rajagriha	Bihar
Anga	Champa	Bihar
Vajji	Vaishali	Bihar
Avanti	Ujjayini, Mahishmati	MP
Matsya	Viratnagar	Rajasthan
Asmaka	Potana	Godavari (only one in the south)
Gandhara, Kamboja	Taxila; Rajapura	North-west

7.2 Republics and Kings

- Not an early republic: **Yaudheya** (a later gana) 1× 1992
- **Pradyota-Avanti, Udayana-Vatsa, Prasenajit-Kosala, Ajatashatru-Magadha** 2× 2000, 2004
- Udayana-Vasavadatta story: **Ujjain** 1× 2008
- Physician **Jivaka**: **Bimbisara's** court 1× 2006

7.3 Rise of Magadha

- Killed his father and was killed by his son: **Ajatashatru** 2× 2007, 2011
- Magadha took Malwa (Avanti) under **Shishunaga** 1× 2008
- Varanasi as second capital: unclear (*); UPPSC accepted **Shishunaga** 1× 2007
- **Aparo Parashurama**: **Mahapadma Nanda** 1× 2010
- Nanda evidence: **Kharavela's Hathigumpha** inscription 1× 2010
- A Nanda king dug a canal in **Kalinga** 1× 1999
- Earliest extant coins: **silver** (punch-marked) 1× 2010

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

DYNASTIES OF MAGADHA

Haryanka
Bimbisara, Ajatashatru, Udayin (founded Pataliputra)

↓

Shishunaga
Shishunaga (took Avanti), Kalashoka (2nd Buddhist council)

↓

Nanda
Mahapadma Nanda (Ugrasena), Dhanananda

↓

Maurya
Chandragupta (322 BCE) with Chanakya

TRAP ALERT

- Kosala's capital is **Shravasti/Saketa**; Ahichhatra is Panchala.
- Surasena = **Mathura**; Vatsa = **Kaushambi**.
- **Asmaka** is the only southern Mahajanapada.
- Earliest coins = silver punch-marked; first king's portrait = Indo-Greek.

UP LINK

UP link: eight Mahajanapadas lay in present UP: **Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Panchala, Surasena, Malla, Chedi** (Bundelkhand part) and part of **Kuru**; capitals such as **Shravasti, Kaushambi, Ahichhatra** (Bareilly), **Mathura** and **Varanasi** are all in UP.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. 16 Mahajanapadas = Anguttara Nikaya; 8 in UP
2. Kuru = Indraprastha; Panchala = Ahichhatra; Kosala = Shravasti, Saketa
3. Vatsa = Kaushambi; Surasena = Mathura; Chedi = Suktimati
4. Anga = Champa; Matsya = Viratnagar (Rajasthan); Asmaka = Potana
5. Ujjain = Avantika; Kalpi on the Yamuna
6. Pradyota = Avanti; Udayana = Vatsa; Prasenajit = Kosala
7. Jivaka = Bimbisara's physician
8. Ajatashatru: patricide and killed by his son
9. Shishunaga took Malwa; Mahapadma = Aparo Parashurama
10. Silver punch-marked = earliest coins

Chapter 8

Greek Invasion

Built from 5 UPPSC questions (1998–2015). Focus: Alexander's campaign, Porus, Massaga, the reasons for his success, and his companions versus later Greek envoys.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- Alexander defeated **Porus** on the **Jhelum** (Hydaspes), 326 BCE **1×** 2013
- Alexander succeeded through **no central power, a superior army, traitor allies** (1, 2, 3) **3×** 2000, 2002, 2003

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

8.1 Alexander in India

- Women took up arms against Alexander at **Massaga** (Assakenoi) **1×** 2013
- Defeated on the Jhelum: **Porus** **1×** 2013
- Success: **no central power, superior army, help from traitors** (1, 2, 3) **3×** 2000, 2002, 2003
- Alexander left India in 325 BCE; he was **not** defeated by Chandragupta (A true, R false) **1×** 1998
- Did not come with Alexander: **Deimachus** (later envoy to Bindusara) **1×** 2015

ALEXANDER'S INDIAN CAMPAIGN

327 BCE
Crosses the Hindu Kush; Ambhi of Taxila submits

↓

Massaga
Fierce resistance; women fight

↓

326 BCE
Battle of the Hydaspes (Jhelum) with Porus

↓

Beas (Hyphasis)
Army refuses to go further

↓

325 BCE
Returns; dies at Babylon, 323 BCE

Greek	Role
Nearchus, Onesicritus	Alexander's companions (wrote accounts)
Megasthenes	Envoy of Seleucus to Chandragupta; Indica
Deimachus	Envoy to Bindusara
Dionysius	Sent by Ptolemy II to Ashoka's time
Heliodorus	Indo-Greek envoy; Besnagar pillar

TRAP ALERT

- Battle with Porus = **Jhelum**; Alexander turned back at the **Beas**.
- Ambhi **helped** Alexander; Porus fought him.
- Deimachus and Megasthenes came **after** Alexander.

UP LINK

UP link: Alexander never reached the Ganga valley; the Nanda power of Magadha, whose realm included eastern UP, is one reason his army refused to march beyond the Beas.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Massaga women fought Alexander
2. Porus defeated on the Jhelum (Hydaspes)
3. Ambhi of Taxila sided with Alexander
4. Army stopped at the Beas
5. Alexander left India in 325 BCE, undefeated
6. Success = disunity, strong army, traitors
7. Deimachus = envoy to Bindusara, not a companion
8. Megasthenes = envoy to Chandragupta
9. Nearchus = Alexander's admiral
10. Alexander died at Babylon, 323 BCE

Chapter 9

Maurya Empire

Built from 57 UPPSC questions (1990–2024). Focus: Chandragupta and Kautilya, Greek envoys, Megasthenes' Indica, the Junagadh inscription, Ashokan edicts and their decipherment, Dhamma, officials and revenue, Mauryan art.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **James Prinsep** first read Brahmi and Ashoka's edicts (1837) **4×** 2006, 2008, 2010, 2014
- **Junagadh** inscription of **Rudradaman**: names Chandragupta (Sudarshana lake) and Ashoka; Ashoka's edicts are on the same rock **7×** 1996, 2002, 2004, 2006, 2007, 2010, 2016
- **Megasthenes' Indica**: seven classes, no slavery, city administration; he came under **Chandragupta** **4×** 2008, 2009, 2013, 2017
- **Rock Edict XIII** = Kalinga war; **RE XII** = religious tolerance; **RE II** = southern kingdoms **5×** 2005, 2008, 2016, 2016, 2022
- Name "Ashoka" appears at **Gujarra** (Datia, MP) and Maski **2×** 2008, 2015

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

9.1 Chandragupta and Kautilya

- First Indian empire: **Chandragupta Maurya** **1×** 2002
- First to conquer Malwa, Gujarat, Maharashtra: **Chandragupta Maurya** **1×** 1991
- Defeated Seleucus: **305 BCE** **1×** 2014
- Mauryas: culture, provinces, rule up to the Hindu Kush (A, C, D); **no gold coins** **1×** 1990
- Kautilya: minister of **Chandragupta Maurya**; childhood name **Vishnugupta** **3×** 2002, 2002, 2006
- Arthashastra: a book on **governance**; compared with Machiavelli's **Prince** **2×** 1994, 2012
- Seventh limb of the Saptanga state: **Mitra** (ally) **1×** 2015

9.2 Greek Contacts and Megasthenes

- Sandrokottos met Alexander: **Justin** **1×** 2008

- **Megasthenes**: under **Chandragupta**; **Deimachus**: under **Bindusara** 2× 2015, 2017
- **Chandragupta-Sandrokottos, Bindusara-Amitraghata, Ashoka-Piyadasi, Chanakya-Vishnugupta** 1× 2001
- No slavery in India: **Megasthenes' Indica** 1× 2013
- Seven classes of society: **Indica** 1× 2008
- City administration: **Indica** 1× 2009
- **Kumrahar** and **Bulandibagh**: **Pataliputra** 2× 2008, 2011

9.3 Inscriptions

- Chandragupta's sway in the west: **Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman** 2× 1996, 2010
- Water management at Girnar: **Chandragupta and Ashoka** (2 and 3) 1× 2006
- First lake at Girnar (Sudarshana): **Chandragupta Maurya** 2× 2002, 2007
- Names both Chandragupta and Ashoka: **Junagadh** inscription 1× 2004
- Ashokan edicts also found at **Junagadh** (Girnar rock) 1× 2016
- Earliest stone inscriptions: **Prakrit** 1× 2009
- Brahmi deciphered from **stone** inscriptions 1× 2008
- First to read Ashoka's edicts and Brahmi: **James Prinsep** 4× 2006, 2008, 2010, 2014
- Pre-Ashokan Brahmi: **Anuradhapura** 1× 2008
- Ashoka named: **Gujarra** (Datia, MP) 2× 2008, 2015
- **Kalsi** (Uttarakhand): Ashoka's **rock edicts** 1× 2008

9.4 Kalinga and Dhamma

- Kalinga war known from **Rock Edict XIII** 1× 2016
- Ashoka annexed Kalinga as it held the routes to the south (A and R true, R explains A) 1× 2002
- Religious tolerance: **Rock Edict XII** 2× 2008, 2022
- Southern kingdom not named: **Satavahana** 1× 2005
- Southern kingdoms named in **Rock Edict II** 1× 2016
- **Ptolemy Philadelphus**: king of **Egypt**; the **Mauryas** dealt with Syria and Egypt 3× 2006, 2010, 2012
- Dhamma linked to Buddhist texts; **Dhamma Mahamattas** from the 14th year (both per key) 1× 2024
- Rajdharma of patience, liberty and compassion: **Ashoka** 1× 1993
- "All people should do good deeds...": **Ashoka** (initial key: Harsha) 1× 2023
- First hospitals and herbal gardens: **Ashoka** 1× 2015
- Pilgrimage route: **Lumbini, Kapilavastu, Gaya, Sarnath, Kushinagar, Shravasti** 1× 1999

Edict	Subject
Rock Edict I	Ban on animal sacrifice
Rock Edict II	Medical care; Cholas, Pandyas, Satiyaputras, Keralaputras
Rock Edict V	Dhamma Mahamattas
Rock Edict XII	Religious tolerance
Rock Edict XIII	Kalinga war; Greek kings
Minor RE (Maski, Gujarra)	Name "Ashoka"
Rummindei pillar	Lumbini, birth of Buddha

9.5 Administration, Economy and Art

- Revenue head: **Samaharta** 1× 2008
- Weights and measures: **Pautavadhyaksha** 1× 2012
- **Rajjukas**: Mauryan **officers** 1× 1996
- **Agronomoi**: **road building** (per key) 1× 2020
- **Bhaga and bali**: **revenue** 1× 1996
- **Sita**: income from **crown land** 1× 2013
- **Sarthavaha**: **merchants' caravan** 1× 2008
- Mauryas gave no religious land grants; no peasant revolt (A true, R false) 1× 2004
- Not true of Barabar caves: dated to the **6th century BCE** (they are Ashokan) 1× 2017
- Correct: **Lothal dockyard, Sarnath sermon, Nalanda learning** (1, 2, 4); Rajgir has no lion capital 1× 2004
- Remarriage prohibited: **Manusmriti** 2× 2002, 2003
- Manu called foreigners **fallen Kshatriyas** 1× 2014

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

TRAP ALERT

- Junagadh inscription is **Rudradaman's** (Shaka, 150 CE), not Mauryan.
- **Megasthenes** = Chandragupta; **Deimachus** = Bindusara.
- Prinsep read Brahmi (1837); the name Ashoka was found at **Maski** in 1915.
- Mauryas issued **silver** punch-marked coins, not gold.

UP LINK

UP link: Ashokan relics in UP include the **Sarnath lion capital** (national emblem), the **Allahabad (Kaushambi) pillar** with Samudragupta's later inscription, the **Meerut pillar** (now in Delhi) and Rummindei-area sites at **Piprahwa**; Kalsi was in UP until 2000.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Chandragupta = first empire; beat Seleucus 305 BCE
2. Kautilya = Vishnugupta; Arthashastra; Mitra = 7th limb
3. Megasthenes (Indica) under Chandragupta; Deimachus under Bindusara
4. Bindusara = Amitraghata; Ashoka = Piyadasi
5. Junagadh (Rudradaman) names Chandragupta and Ashoka
6. Prinsep read Brahmi; Gujarra and Maski name Ashoka
7. RE XIII = Kalinga; RE XII = tolerance; RE II = south kingdoms
8. Samaharta = revenue; Pautavadhyaksha = weights
9. Sita = crown land; sarthavaha = caravan
10. Kumrahar, Bulandibagh = Pataliputra

Chapter 10

Post-Mauryan Period

Built from 47 UPPSC questions (1990–2023). Focus: Shungas, Satavahanas, Kharavela, the order of foreign invaders, Indo-Greek and Kushan coins, Rudradaman, Kanishka's court, the Vikram and Saka eras, Gandhara art.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Saka era = 78 CE**; **Vikram Samvat = 57 BCE**; gap **135 years** 6× 1990, 1992, 2002, 2006, 2007, 2013
- **Vima Kadphises** issued gold coins first and regularly; **Kushans** issued most copper coins; Buddha on **Kanishka's** coins 5× 2004, 2005, 2009, 2010, 2015
- **Kanishka's court**: **Ashvaghosha, Vasumitra** (not Patanjali, Kalidasa or Vishakhadatta) 4× 1994, 2005, 2008, 2008
- **Satavahanas**: strongest southern power after the Mauryas; founder **Simuka**; capital **Pratishthana** (Amaravati in options) 5× 1993, 2001, 2005, 2008, 2008
- **Kharavela** (Chedi, Kalinga): patron of **Jainism**, **Hathigumpha** inscription 4× 2008, 2014, 2015, 2018

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

10.1 Shungas, Satavahanas and Kharavela

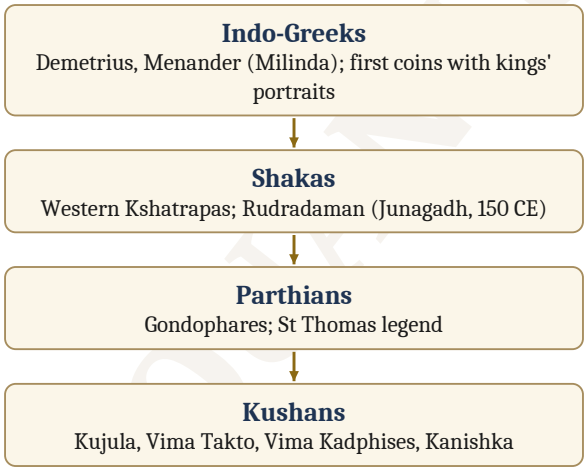
- Pushyamitra's two **Ashvamedhas**: **Ayodhya** inscription (Dhanadeva) 1× 2018
- **Patanjali** was a contemporary of **Pushyamitra Shunga** 1× 2011
- Strongest southern dynasty after the Mauryas: **Satavahana** 1× 1993
- **Simuka** founded the **Satavahana** dynasty 1× 2008
- Earliest dynasty among the options: **Satavahana** 1× 2001
- Satavahana capital: **Pratishthana** (Paithan); **Amaravati** in the 2005 options 2× 2005, 2008
- **Ekabrahmana**: **Gautamiputra Satakarni** 1× 2016
- Satavahanas promoted Sanskrit with Prakrit (A and R true, R explains A, per key) 1× 2017

- Satavahanas nurtured **Prakrit** and public art (both) 1× 2021
- "Shriparvatiya" in the Puranas: **Ikshvakus** 1× 2020
- Patron of Jainism: **Kharavela**, of the **Chedi** dynasty; **Hathigumpha** inscription 4× 2008, 2014, 2015, 2018
- Wrong pair: **Bhitari-Pulakeshin II** (Bhitari = Skandagupta) 1× 2017

10.2 Foreign Invaders

- Order: **Greeks, Sakas, Kushans** 1× 2023
- **Demetrius-Indo-Greek, Rudradaman-Scythian, Gondophares-Parthian, Vima-Kushan** 1× 2017
- Lead coins: **Strato II** 1× 2014
- Sankarshana and Vasudeva on coins of **Agathocles** 1× 2017
- Earliest **kavya**-style inscription: **Rudradaman** (Junagadh) 1× 1997
- Repaired Sudarshana lake without forced labour: **Rudradaman I** 1× 2014
- **Gandhara art-Kushans, Junagadh-Rudradaman I, Milindapanho-Menander, Taxila inscription-Patika** 1× 2017

ORDER OF INVADERS



10.3 Kanishka and the Kushans

- Sarnath image of Kanishka: **81 CE** (year 3, if he began in 78) 1× 2014
- Kanishka's coronation: **78 CE** 1× 1991
- Not in the Rabatak inscription: **Shravasti** 1× 2014
- Contemporaries: **Ashvaghosha, Vasumitra** (I and II) 1× 1994
- Ashvaghosha: contemporary of **Kanishka** 1× 2008
- Not at Kanishka's court: **Patanjali**, **Vishakhadatta** 2× 2005, 2008
- Taxila-educated physicians: **Jivaka** (and Charaka by tradition) 1× 2015
- **Takshashila**: between the **Indus and Jhelum** 1× 1996
- Most copper coins: **Kushans** 1× 2005
- First and regular gold coins: **Vima Kadphises** (Kushans) 3× 2004, 2009, 2015
- Buddha on coins of **Kanishka** 1× 2010

10.4 Coins, Eras, Trade and Art

- Wrong pair: **Satavahanas-gold** (they issued lead, potin, silver) 1× 2016
- Kardamaka Kshatrapas' rare coins: **copper** (per key) 1× 2019
- **Kartikeya** on **Yaudheya** coins 1× 2008
- **Vikram Samvat**: **57 BCE** 1× 1992
- **Saka Samvat**: **78 CE** 2× 1990, 2013
- Saka 556 = **634 CE** 1× 2002
- December 2009 = Saka **1931** 1× 2007
- Saka-Vikram gap: **135 years** 1× 2006
- Kushans traded via the Gulf and Red Sea; they had no great navy (A true, R false) 1× 1998
- **Gandhara** art: **Indian and Greek** blend 1× 1996
- **Bamiyan**: giant **Buddha statues** 1× 2008

School	Material	Patron	Feature
Gandhara	Grey schist	Kushans	Greek style, wavy hair
Mathura	Red sandstone	Kushans	Indian style; first Buddha images (also)
Amaravati	White marble	Satavahanas	Narrative reliefs

TRAP ALERT

- Vikram = CE **+ 57**; Saka = CE **- 78**; Saka date to CE: add 78.
- Satavahana coins are **lead**, not gold; gold = Kushans and Guptas.
- Order: Greeks, Shakas, Parthians, Kushans.
- Bhitari = **Skandagupta**; Hathigumpha = **Kharavela**; Ayodhya = **Pushyamitra**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Mathura** was the second Kushan capital and gave its name to the Mathura school of art; **Ayodhya** has Dhanadeva's inscription on Pushyamitra's two Ashvamedhas, and **Sarnath** has Kanishka's dated Buddha image.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Ayodhya inscription = Pushyamitra; Patanjali = his contemporary
2. Simuka founded the Satavahanas; Ekabrahmana = Gautamiputra
3. Kharavela = Chedi, Jain, Hathigumpha
4. Greeks, Shakas, Parthians, Kushans
5. Rudradaman = earliest kavya inscription; Sudarshana repair
6. Kanishka 78 CE; Ashvaghosha and Vasumitra at his court
7. Vima Kadphises = first regular gold coins
8. Vikram 57 BCE; Saka 78 CE; gap 135
9. Yaudheya coins = Kartikeya
10. Gandhara = Indo-Greek art; Bamiyan Buddhas

Chapter 11

Gupta and Post-Gupta Period

Built from 69 UPPSC questions (1990–2024). Focus: Gupta kings and titles, the Prayag Prashasti, Chandragupta II, coins and inscriptions, the Hunas, administration and trade, Harsha, Chinese travellers, court poets, the six schools of philosophy.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Samudragupta**: **Prayag Prashasti** (Allahabad pillar, by Harishena), "**Napoleon of India**", Parakramanka **8×** 1990, 2004, 2004, 2009, 2009, 2015, 2015, 2016
- **Harsha**: capital **Kannauj**; assemblies at **Kannauj and Prayag**; defeated by **Pulakeshin II**; **Hiuen Tsang** came in his reign **7×** 1990, 1992, 1993, 2001, 2004, 2012, 2016
- **Skandagupta** beat the **Hunas** (**Bhitari** pillar); **Yashodharman** beat Mihirakula **5×** 1993, 2006, 2014, 2015, 2016
- **Six schools**: **Sankhya-Kapila, Yoga-Patanjali, Nyaya-Gautama** **9×** 1997, 1998, 2002, 2003, 2005, 2005, 2007, 2010, 2023
- **Coins**: gold **dinara**, silver **rupaka**; first coins **Chandragupta I**, first silver **Chandragupta II** **6×** 1992, 2002, 2010, 2010, 2011, 2017

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

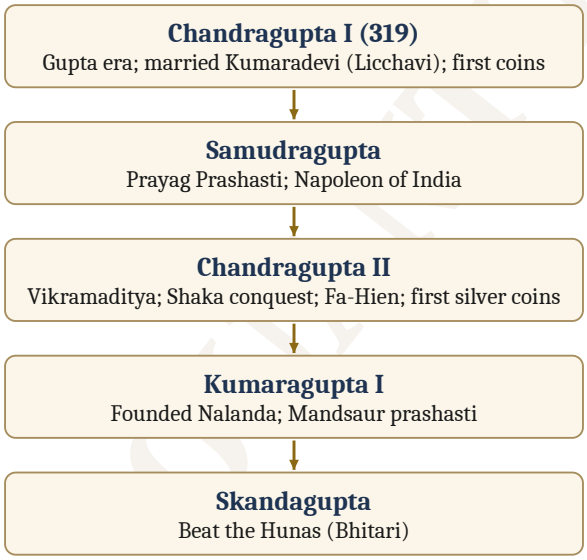
11.1 The Gupta Rulers

- **Chandragupta I-Kumaradevi, Samudragupta-Dattadevi, Chandragupta II-Kuberanaga, Kumaragupta I-Anantadevi** **1×** 2019
- **Ashoka-Priyadarshi, Samudragupta-Parakramanka, Chandragupta II-Vikramaditya, Skandagupta-Kramaditya** **1×** 2015
- **Devagupta**: **Chandragupta II** **1×** 2007
- Vikram 58 BCE, Saka 78 CE, Gupta 319 CE, Muslim rule 1192 (all four per key) **1×** 2011

11.2 Samudragupta and Chandragupta II

- Allahabad pillar: reign of **Samudragupta**; **Prayag Prashasti** = his campaigns **2×** 2004, 2004
- Also on the pillar: an inscription of **Jahangir** **1×** 2016
- **Dhananjaya-Kusthalapura, Nilaraja-Avamukta, Ugrasena-Palakka, Vishnugopa-Kanchi** **1×** 2018
- **Napoleon of India**: **Samudragupta** **2×** 1990, 2009
- First "Parama Bhagavata": **Samudragupta** (Commission accepted Chandragupta II) **2×** 2009, 2015
- "Prithivyah Pratham Veer": **Samudragupta** (question dropped) **1×** 2016
- Four Ashvamedhas: **Pravarasena I** (Vakataka) **2×** 2003, 2011
- **Shaka conqueror**: **Chandragupta II**; his silver coins (about 33 grains) prove it (both) **2×** 2010, 2022
- Delhi iron pillar: **Chandra** (Chandragupta II) **1×** 2002
- Navaratna linked with astrology: **Kshapanaka** **1×** 2008

IMPERIAL GUPTAS



11.3 Coins and Inscriptions

- Gold coin: **dinara**; silver coin: **rupaka** **3×** 1992, 2002, 2017
- First Gupta coins: **Chandragupta I**; first silver: **Chandragupta II** **3×** 2010, 2010, 2011
- **Mandsaur** prashasti: **Kumaragupta I** **1×** 2021
- Wrong pair: **Prabhavati Gupta-Udayagiri cave** **1×** 2017
- First record of sati: **Eran** (510 CE) **1×** 2010
- Most hurt by the Huna invasions: **Guptas** **1×** 1993
- Hunas came under **Skandagupta**, who defeated them (**Bhitari** pillar) **3×** 2006, 2014, 2015
- Defeated Mihirakula: **Yashodharman** **1×** 2016

11.4 Administration, Economy and Society

- Order: **bhukti, vishaya, vithi, grama** **1×** 2023
- Lawful tax: **one-sixth** of produce **1×** 1992
- Irrigation tax: **bidakabhagam** **1×** 2009
- North Indian port: **Tamralipti** **1×** 2014
- River ports and large entrepots existed (both) **1×** 2024
- **Warangal** (3rd century): **iron implements** **1×** 2001
- **Kausheya**: **silk** **1×** 2008
- "Golden Age": **Guptas** **1×** 2004
- Women equal to men: **none** of the ages **1×** 1994
- Post-Gupta feudalism: landlords and dependent peasants (A and R true, R explains A) **1×** 2004
- Gupta Ayurveda author: no option fits (*) **1×** 2002
- Chess began in **India** **1×** 2004

11.5 Harsha and the Post-Guptas

- Wrong pair: **Sarvavarman-Gaya copper plate** **1×** 2022
- Harsha's capital: **Kannauj** (moved from **Thanesar**) **2×** 1992, 1993
- Harsha's sources (key): **Kalhana** (main ones: Bana, Hiuen Tsang) **1×** 1995
- Assemblies at **Kannauj and Prayag**; Buddhist assembly in UP at **Prayag** **2×** 2001, 2004
- Harsha was defeated by **Pulakeshin II** **1×** 2016
- **Kushans-Devaputra, Pulakeshin II-Dakshinapatheshwara, Harsha-Sakalottarapathanatha** **1×** 2023
- Hiuen Tsang came under **Harsha**; his book **Si-Yu-Ki**; studied at **Nalanda** **4×** 1990, 1995, 2012, 2016

- Who sent Hiuen Tsang to Harsha: **none** (he came on his own) 1× 2007
- Chinese name for India: **Yin-tu** 1× 2013
- Travellers' dates: two pairs wrong (*) 1× 2021

Traveller	Came under	Note
Fa-Hien	Chandragupta II	399-414 CE; Fo-Kuo-Ki
Hiuen Tsang	Harsha	Si-Yu-Ki; studied at Nalanda
I-Tsing	Post-Harsha	671-695 CE; Nalanda

11.6 Poets, Religion and Philosophy

- Wrong pair: **Harishena-Harsha** (Harishena = Samudragupta) 1× 1997
- **Amir Khusrau-Alauddin, Kalidasa-Chandragupta II, Harishena-Samudragupta, Banabhatta-Harsha** 1× 2003
- Multan sun temple and Sambapur pilgrimage (both) 1× 2020
- Not true of Shankaracharya: he named **Prayag Tirtharaj** 1× 2005
- Shankaracharya: born in **Kerala**; maths at **Joshimath, Dwarka, Puri, Sringeri** 2× 1999, 2006
- Chief seat of the lunar dynasty: **Pratishthanpur** (Jhunsi, Prayagraj) 1× 2009
- **Sankhya**: **Kapila** 2× 1998, 2010
- **Yoga**: **Patanjali** 4× 1997, 2002, 2003, 2007
- **Nyaya**: **Gautama** 3× 2005, 2005, 2023
- **Nyaya-logic, Mimamsa-Vedic rites, Sankhya-real knowledge, Vedanta-self-knowledge** 1× 2019
- Theory of karma: **Mimamsa** 1× 1997
- Navya-Nyaya founder: **Gangesha** (Udayana also accepted) 1× 1995

School	Founder
Sankhya	Kapila
Yoga	Patanjali
Nyaya	Gautama (Akshapada)
Vaisheshika	Kanada
Mimamsa	Jaimini
Vedanta	Badarayana

TRAP ALERT

- Harishena wrote for **Samudragupta**, not Harsha.
- First coins = Chandragupta I; first **silver** = Chandragupta II.
- Skandagupta beat the first Hunas; **Yashodharman** beat Mihirakula.
- Four Ashvamedhas = **Pravarasena I**, not Samudragupta.

UP LINK

UP link: the **Allahabad pillar** (Prayag Prashasti, plus Ashoka and Jahangir), **Bhitari** (Ghazipur, Skandagupta's pillar), the **Deogarh Dashavatara temple** (Lalitpur), **Kannauj** as Harsha's capital, Harsha's **Prayag assembly**, and **Pratishthanpur** (Jhunsi) are all in UP.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Chandragupta I = Kumaradevi; first coins; Gupta era 319
2. Samudragupta = Prayag Prashasti, Napoleon, Parakramanka
3. Chandragupta II = Vikramaditya, Shaka conqueror, iron pillar, first silver
4. Kumaragupta = Mandsaur; Skandagupta = Bhitari, Hunas
5. Dinara gold; rupaka silver; Eran = first sati record
6. Bhukti, vishaya, vithi, grama
7. Harsha: Kannauj; Prayag assembly; beaten by Pulakeshin II
8. Hiuen Tsang = Si-Yu-Ki, Nalanda; Fa-Hien = Chandragupta II
9. Harishena = Samudragupta; Bana = Harsha; Kalidasa = Chandragupta II
10. Kapila Sankhya; Patanjali Yoga; Gautama Nyaya

Chapter 12

Architecture in Ancient India

Built from 54 UPPSC questions (1991–2023). Focus: Ellora and the Kailasa temple, Elephanta, Gupta temples of UP, Khajuraho, Konark and Lingaraja, Mamallapuram, Chola temples, Angkor Wat, Jain temples, site-state matching.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Kailasa temple, Ellora** = rock-cut, built by the **Rashtrakutas**; Ellora has **Hindu, Buddhist and Jain** caves **14×** 1998, 1999, 2001, 2002, 2002, 2004, 2005, 2006, 2007, 2008, 2009, 2010, 2010, 2012
- **Khajuraho** = **Chandelas**; Hindu and Jain temples **7×** 1991, 1993, 1994, 1996, 2008, 2010, 2010
- **Konark Sun Temple** (Black Pagoda) = **Narasimhadeva I**; **Lingaraja** = Bhubaneswar, Nagara style **8×** 1993, 1995, 1997, 2001, 2004, 2006, 2009, 2010
- **Mamallapuram rathas** = **Pallavas** (Narasimhavarman I); smallest = **Draupadi ratha** **5×** 1994, 2007, 2011, 2014, 2015
- **Elephanta** = **Shaiva** caves, Trimurti (Maheshamurti) **5×** 2002, 2003, 2007, 2009, 2011

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

12.1 Rock-cut Caves

- Over 100 Buddhist caves: **Kanheri** **1×** 2002
- Ajanta and Ellora: **Maharashtra** **1×** 1993
- Ellora caves and Kailasa temple: **Rashtrakutas** (Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar) **8×** 1999, 2001, 2004, 2005, 2008, 2009, 2010, 2010
- Ellora: **Hindu, Buddhist and Jain** caves together **4×** 1998, 2002, 2002, 2006
- Rock-cut temple: **Kailasa, Ellora** **2×** 2007, 2012
- Rashtrakutas patronised **Jainism** (per key) **1×** 2010
- Elephanta: mainly **Shaiva** (with Buddhist remains); ascribed to the **Rashtrakutas** (per key) **4×** 2002, 2003, 2007, 2009
- **Trimurti**: **Elephanta** **1×** 2011

12.2 Stupas and Gupta Temples

- **Ayaka pillars**: **Amaravati** **1×** 2022
- **Stupa-Sanchi, painting-Bagh, headless Kanishka statue-Mathura, Dashavatara temple-Deogarh** **1×** 2017
- **Surkhi** introduced by the **Kushans** (per key) **1×** 2014
- **Brick temple-Bhitargaon, Dashavatara-Deogarh, Shiva temple-Bhumara, Vishnu temple-Eran** **1×** 2013
- **Bhitargaon** (Kanpur): 5th-6th century, one of the **oldest brick temples** (both) **1×** 2021

12.3 Temple Styles and Regional Temples

- **Gopuram**: ornate multi-storey **gateway** towers **1×** 1998
- Dravida-style pinnacle: **Teli ka Mandir, Gwalior** **1×** 2016
- Kandariya Mahadeva: **Chandelas** **1×** 1991
- Khajuraho temples: **Hindu and Jain** **1×** 1993
- **Matangeshvara**, Khajuraho: **Shiva** **1×** 2010
- Correct pair: **Khajuraho-Chandelas** **4×** 1994, 1996, 2008, 2010
- Konark: **Narasimhadeva**; "**Black Pagoda**"; the Sun temple **4×** 1993, 1995, 2006, 2009
- Largest and tallest Odisha temple: **Lingaraja**, at **Bhubaneswar** **3×** 2001, 2004, 2010
- Bhubaneswar and Puri temples: **Nagara** style **1×** 1997
- **Sun temple-Konark, Lingaraja-Bhubaneswar, Hawa Mahal-Jaipur, Gommateshwara-Karnataka** **1×** 1992

Style	Region	Mark
Nagara	North (Khajuraho, Odisha)	Curved shikhara
Dravida	South (Thanjavur, Madurai)	Pyramidal vimana, gopurams
Vesara	Deccan (Chalukyas, Hoysalas)	Mix of both

12.4 South India and Abroad

- Mamallapuram rathas: **Pallavas** (Narasimhavarman I) **4×** 1994, 2007, 2014, 2015

- Smallest ratha: **Draupadi** 1× 2011
- Order (key): **Sapta Pagoda, Shore Temple, Brihadishvara, Gangaikondacholapuram** 1× 2018
- Biggest Nandi (key): **Brihadishvara**, Thanjavur (Lepakshi also claimed) 1× 1999
- Brihadishvara built by **Rajaraja I** 1× 2008
- **Angkor Wat**: **Cambodia**; begun under **Suryavarman II** 4× 1992, 1993, 1995, 2006
- **Borobudur**: **Java** 1× 2013

12.5 Jain Temples, Sites and Pilgrimages

- Dilwara (Abu) Jain temples: **marble**; at **Mount Abu, Rajasthan** 3× 2010, one-liner, one-liner
- **Sonagiri** Jain temples: near **Datia, MP** 2× 1996, 2005
- **Elephanta-cave, Shravanabelagola-statue, Khajuraho-temple, Sanchi-stupa** 1× 2001
- **Hampi-Karnataka, Nagarjunakonda-Andhra, Shishupalgarh-Odisha, Arikamedu-Puducherry** 1× 2014
- **Bhimbetka-MP, Shore temple-TN, Hampi-Karnataka, Manas-Assam** 1× 2010
- **Baidyanath-Shiva, Sarnath-first sermon, Dilwara-Jain, Badrinath-Vishnu** 1× 2004
- Brahma temple of **Pushkar**: **Rajasthan** 1× 2023
- **Naimisharanya**: **Sitapur** 1× 2002

TRAP ALERT

- Kailasa (Ellora) = **Rashtrakutas** (Krishna I); not Chalukya or Pallava.
- Shore Temple is **structural**, not rock-cut; the rathas are rock-cut.
- Brihadishvara = **Rajaraja I**; Gangaikondacholapuram = Rajendra I.
- Konark = Narasimhadeva I (Eastern Ganga); Sonagiri = Datia (MP), not Jhansi.

UP LINK

UP link: the oldest surviving Gupta temples are in UP: the **Dashavatara temple, Deogarh** (Lalitpur) and the brick **Bhitargaon temple** (Kanpur); **Sarnath** and **Mathura** show early sculpture, and **Naimisharanya** (Sitapur) is a major pilgrimage.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Kanheri = 100+ caves; Ajanta, Ellora = Maharashtra
2. Ellora (three faiths), Kailasa = Rashtrakutas
3. Elephanta = Shaiva, Trimurti
4. Bhitargaon = brick (Kanpur); Deogarh = Dashavatara (Lalitpur)
5. Khajuraho = Chandelas; Kandariya = Shiva
6. Konark = Black Pagoda (Narasimhadeva); Lingaraja = Bhubaneswar
7. Mamallapuram rathas = Pallavas; Draupadi ratha smallest
8. Brihadishvara = Rajaraja I; Angkor Wat = Cambodia; Borobudur = Java
9. Dilwara = marble, Mount Abu; Sonagiri = Datia
10. Pushkar = Rajasthan; Naimisharanya = Sitapur

Chapter 13

South India: Chola, Chalukya, Pallava and Sangam Period

Built from 47 UPPSC questions (1991–2025). Focus: southern dynasties and capitals, Sangam literature and ports, Arikamedu, Pallavas, Pulakeshin II and Aihole, Rashtrakutas, Rajaraja I and Rajendra I, Chola village government, Nataraja bronzes.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Rajendra I**: Bay of Bengal a "**Chola lake**", founded **Gangaikondacholapuram**, built the **Cholagangam** tank; **Rajaraja I** took northern Sri Lanka **5×** 2008, 2008, 2014, 2016, 2023
- **Arikamedu** (Poduke) = Roman trade and settlement; amphora jars **6×** 1997, 2001, 2002, 2003, 2009, 2014
- **Chola** special feature: **village autonomy**; famed for **naval power**; Nataraja bronze = **Chola art** **5×** 1991, 1992, 1995, 2004, 2006
- **Chalukyas of Badami**: capital **Vatapi**; greatest **Pulakeshin II**; **Aihole** inscription mentions **Kalidasa** **4×** 1991, 1991, 2004, 2013
- **Sangam**: third Sangam at **Madurai**; **Tolkappiyam** = grammar; Silappadikaram by **Ilango**; Pallavas were **not** a Sangam dynasty **5×** 1997, 2002, 2006, 2010, 2014

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice **4×** times asked, followed by the exam years

13.1 Dynasties and Capitals

- **Mahendravarman I-Pallava, Kadungon-Pandya, Amoghavarsha I-Rashtrakuta, Rajaraja I-Chola** **1×** 2025
- **Chalukyas-Badami, Pallavas-Kanchipuram, Harsha-Kannauj, Pandyas-Madurai** **1×** 2004

Dynasty	Capital
Chalukyas of Badami	Vatapi (Badami)
Eastern Chalukyas	Vengi
Pallavas	Kanchipuram
Rashtrakutas	Manyakheta
Cholas	Thanjavur, then Gangaikondacholapuram
Pandyas	Madurai
Kadambas	Vanavasi
Kakatiyas	Warangal

13.2 The Sangam Age

- Third Sangam: **Madurai** **1×** 2006
- Not a Sangam dynasty: **Pallava** **1×** 2010
- Pandya lifeline (key printed "Vengi"): the **Vaigai** **1×** 2010
- **Meenakshi** temple: **Madurai** **3×** 1991, 1992, 2004
- **Tolkappiyam**: **Tamil grammar** **2×** 1997, 2014
- **Silappadikaram**: **Ilango Adigal** **1×** 2002
- **Tirukkural-philosophy, Tolkappiyam-grammar, Silappadikaram-love story, Manimekalai-merchant's tale** **1×** 2014
- "Laghuveda": **Kural** **1×** 2013
- Tamil Ramayana (Ramavataram): **Kamban** **1×** 2010
- Roman trade: **Arikamedu** (Periplus' **Poduke**), a **Roman settlement** **5×** 1997, 2001, 2002, 2003, 2009
- **Amphora**: tall **two-handled jar** **1×** 2014
- West-coast Sangam ports: **Tondi and Muziris** (3 and 4) **1×** 2012

13.3 Pallavas, Chalukyas and Rashtrakutas

- Pallava order: **Mahendravarman I, Narasimhavarman I, Parameshvaravarman I, Nandivarman II** **1×** 2019
- Two naval expeditions to Ceylon (642): **Narasimhavarman I** **1×** 2016
- Chalukya capital: **Vatapi**; greatest king: **Pulakeshin II** **2×** 1991, 1991
- Kalidasa named in Pulakeshin II's **Aihole inscription** **1×** 2013
- Gave women high office: **Chalukyas** **1×** 2007
- China-India relations under the Chalukyas: **Ma Tuan-lin** **1×** 2014
- Sent ministers to stop cruelty to animals in Kashi: **Kumarapala** (Gujarat Chalukya) **1×** 2016
- **Kadamba** capital: **Vanavasi** **1×** 2005
- **Takkolam** (949): **Cholas vs Rashtrakutas** **1×** 2001

13.4 The Imperial Cholas

- Chola empire: **Coromandel coast and part of the Deccan** **1×** 1991
- Capital: **Thanjavur** **1×** 2009
- More known about Cholas: their rule left many records (A and R true, R explains A) **1×** 2020
- Naval power: **Cholas** **2×** 1992, 2004

- Northern Sri Lanka conquered by **Rajaraja I**; he also beat the Chera navy at Kandalur **2×** 2014, 2023
- "Chola lake", **Gangaikondacholapuram**, **Cholagangam**: **Rajendra I** **3×** 2008, 2008, 2016
- Freed Sri Lanka and married his daughter to a Sinhala prince: **Kulottunga I** **1×** 2012
- Heir named in the king's lifetime: unclear (*) **1×** 2001
- Who ended the Cholas: unclear (*); the Pandyas and Hoysalas **1×** 2004
- Special feature: **village self-government** **2×** 1991, 1995
- Garden committee: **Thotta Variyam** **1×** 2013
- Overseas guilds: **Nanadesis, Manigramam** **1×** 2018
- 72 merchants to China: **Kulottunga I** **1×** 1992
- **Nataraja** bronze: **Chola art** **1×** 2006
- Nataraja: four hands; a man's earring right, a woman's left (both) **1×** 2021
- **Dakshinamurti**: Shiva as **teacher** **1×** 2013
- **Rudramadevi** (Kakatiya): fourth ruler; beat Pandyas, Gangas and Yadavas (both) **1×** 2023

CHOLA GREATNESS



TRAP ALERT

- Pallavas are **post-Sangam**; the Sangam kingdoms are Chera, Chola, Pandya.
- Northern Sri Lanka = **Rajaraja I**; whole island and Ganga raid = **Rajendra I**.
- Kalidasa is named in the **Aihole** inscription (Ravikirti) of Pulakeshin II.
- Takkolam was a **Chola defeat** by the Rashtrakuta Krishna III.

UP LINK

UP link: Rajendra I's northern campaign reached the **Ganga** (in Bengal), and Kumarapala's ministers acted in **Kashi**; Varanasi also remained the great learning centre that southern scholars like Shankaracharya visited.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Mahendravarman = Pallava; Amoghavarsha = Rashtrakuta
2. Third Sangam = Madurai; Tolkappiyam = grammar
3. Silappadikaram = Ilango; Kural = Laghuveda; Kamban = Tamil Ramayana
4. Arikamedu = Poduke, Roman trade
5. Narasimhavarman I = Ceylon expeditions, Mamalla
6. Vatapi; Pulakeshin II; Aihole names Kalidasa
7. Takkolam = Chola vs Rashtrakuta
8. Rajaraja I = north Sri Lanka; Rajendra I = Chola lake
9. Chola = village autonomy; Thotta Variyam = gardens
10. Nataraja = Chola bronze; Dakshinamurti = teacher

Chapter 14

Pre-Medieval Period

Built from 32 UPPSC questions (1994–2024). Focus: the tripartite struggle for Kannauj, Palas and Vikramashila, Senas, Gurjara-Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas, Chauhans, Chandelas, Gahadavalas, Paramara Bhoja, Solankis, jurists and travellers.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

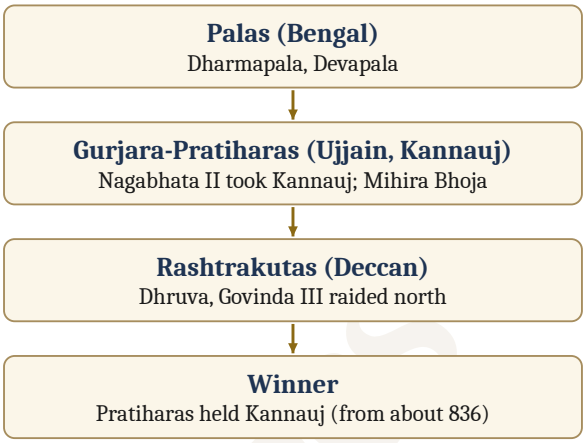
- **Vikramashila** (and Somapura) founded by the Pala **Dharmapala** 9× 1994, 1999, 2002, 2004, 2005, 2008, 2008, 2015, 2016
- **Tripartite struggle** for **Kannauj**: **Palas, Gurjara-Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas** 3× 2002, 2015, one-liner
- **Gurjara-Pratiharas**: founder **Nagabhata I**; greatest **Mihira Bhoja** ("Adivaraha") 5× 2002, 2003, 2010, 2017, 2017
- **Gopala** (Pala founder) was chosen by the people (with Nandivarman Pallavamalla) 2× 2015, 2021
- **Jejakabhukti** = **Bundelkhand** (Chandelas), not Kaushambi 3× 2008, 2017, 2021

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

14.1 Kannauj, Palas and Senas

- Tripartite struggle: **Palas, Gurjaras, Rashtrakutas** (2, 3, 4) 2× 2002, 2015
- "Nagar Mahoday Shri": **Kannauj** 1× 2015
- **Gaudavaho**: **Vakpati** (court of Yashovarman of Kannauj) 1× 2014
- Pala founder: **Gopala** 1× 2015
- Chosen by the people: **Gopala and Nandivarman Pallavamalla** (2 and 4) 1× 2021
- **Vikramashila**: **Dharmapala** (Pala) 8× 1994, 2002, 2004, 2005, 2008, 2008, 2015, 2016
- **Somapura Mahavihara**: **Dharmapala** 1× 1999
- Sena order: **Hemanta, Vijaya, Ballala, Lakshmana** 1× 2024
- New Samvat (Lakshmana era): **Lakshmana Sena** (Senas) 2× 1999, 2005
- **Pundravardhana bhukti**: **North Bengal** 1× 2012

TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE FOR KANNAUJ



14.2 Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas and Rajputs

- Pratihara founder: **Nagabhata I** 2× 2002, 2003
- Greatest Pratihara: **Mihira Bhoja**, titled **Adivaraha** 2× 2010, 2017
- Order: **Vatsaraja, Nagabhata II, Mahendrapala, Mahipala** 1× 2017
- **Hiranyagarbha** ritual: **Dantidurga** (Rashtrakuta) 1× 2015
- Born in a military camp: **Amoghavarsha** 1× 2013
- "Last sun of Indian glory": **Prithviraj** 1× 2016
- Prithviraj Chauhan = **Prithviraja III** 1× 2010
- Wrong pair: **Abdur Rahman-Hammir Raso** 1× 2010

Raso	Poet
Prithviraj Raso	Chand Bardai
Alha Khand	Jagnik
Bisaldev Raso	Narpati Nalha
Hammir Raso	Sharangadhar (Jodhraj)

14.3 Chandelas, Gahadavalas, Paramaras, Solankis

- **Jejakabhukti**: **Bundelkhand** 1× 2008
- Wrong pair: **Jejakabhukti-Kaushambi** 1× 2021
- Chandela order: **Yashovarman, Dhanga, Vidyadhara, Kirtivarman** 1× 2017
- Gahadavala queen **Kumaradevi** built the Dharmachakra Jina Vihara at **Sarnath** 1× 2007
- Udaipur Prashasti praise: **Bhoja** (Paramara) 1× 2023

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

- Book on mechanical devices: **Bhoja** (Samarangana Sutradhara) 1× 2013
- **Bhojshala** deity: **Saraswati** 1× 2001
- **Hemachandra** at **Kumarapala's** court 1× 2010
- Aid to rebuild a Khambhat mosque: **Jayasimha Siddharaja** 1× 1999

14.4 Jurists and Travellers

- Jurists: **Vijnaneshvara, Hemadri, Jimutavahana** (1, 2, 4) 1× 1995
- Order: **Fa-Hien, Hiuen Tsang, I-Tsing, Al-Biruni** 1× 2024

Jurist	Work
Vijnaneshvara	Mitakshara (Chalukya court)
Jimutavahana	Dayabhaga (Bengal)
Hemadri	Chaturvarga Chintamani (Yadavas)

TRAP ALERT

- Mihira Bhoja (Pratihara, Adivaraha) is **not** Bhoja Paramara (Dhar, Udaipur Prashasti).
- Vikramashila and Somapura = Dharmapala; Nalanda = **Kumaragupta I**.
- Jejakabhukti is a **region** (Bundelkhand), not a city.
- The Rashtrakutas raided Kannauj but never held it.

UP LINK

UP link: **Kannauj** was the prize of the tripartite struggle and the Pratihara capital; **Kalinjar** and **Mahoba** were Chandela strongholds in Bundelkhand; the Gahadavalas ruled from **Kannauj and Varanasi**, and Kumaradevi's vihara stands at **Sarnath**.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Kannauj = tripartite prize (Pala, Pratihara, Rashtrakuta)
2. Gopala elected; Dharmapala = Vikramashila, Somapura
3. Lakshmana Sena = Lakshmana era
4. Nagabhata I founded the Pratiharas; Mihira Bhoja = Adivaraha
5. Dantidurga = Hiranyagarbha; Amoghavarsha born in camp
6. Prithviraj III = last sun of Indian glory
7. Jejakabhukti = Bundelkhand (Chandelas)
8. Kumaradevi = Sarnath vihara (Gahadavala)
9. Bhoja Paramara = Bhojshala, Samarangana Sutradhara
10. Hemachandra = Kumarapala's court

Chapter 15

Ancient Literature and Litterateurs

Built from 39 UPPSC questions (1992–2025). Focus: author-book matching for grammar, drama, poetry, history, law, medicine, mathematics and music; Kalidasa, Harsha, Kalhana, Jayadeva, Aryabhata and Bhaskara.

ASKED MOST · REVISE FIRST

- **Author-book matching**: **Panini-Ashtadhyayi, Patanjali-Mahabhashya, Yaska-Nirukta, Katyayana-Varttika, Vatsyayana-Kamasutra, Chanakya-Arthashastra, Kalhana-Rajatarangini** 3× 1992, 2010, 2017
- **Harsha** wrote **Priyadarshika, Nagananda, Ratnavali**; Karpuramanjari is **Rajashekhara's** 3× 2006, 2012, 2014
- **Kalidasa**: Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha, **Malavikagnimitra** (hero **Agnimitra**); not Shringarashataka 2× 1998, 2025
- **Kalhana's Rajatarangini**: **eight** tarangas; continued by **Jonaraja and Srivara** 3× 2000, 2010, 2015
- **Bhaskara II**: algebra, **Lilavati**; **Aryabhata**: place value; zero by **Indians** 5× 2002, 2002, 2014, 2015, 2017

■ asked 3 or more times • asked once or twice 4× times asked, followed by the exam years

15.1 Epics, Grammar and Classics

- Vishnu Purana on the Mauryas; Vayu Purana on the Guptas (both) 1× 2023
- "Thy right is to work only...": **Gita** 1× 1992
- "What is here is found elsewhere...": **Mahabharata** 1× 1992
- **Panini-Ashtadhyayi, Vatsyayana-Kamasutra, Chanakya-Arthashastra, Kalhana-Rajatarangini** 1× 1992
- **Ashtadhyayi**: **Panini** 1× 2010
- **Ashtadhyayi-Panini, Mahabhashya-Patanjali, Nirukta-Yaska, Varttika-Katyayana** 1× 2017
- Gupta-age works: **Amarakosha, Kamasutra, Meghaduta, Mudrarakshasa** (all, per key) 1× 2009
- Not by Kalidasa: **Shringarashataka** (Bhartrihari) 1× 2025
- Hero of Malavikagnimitra: **Agnimitra** 1× 1998

15.2 Dramatists and Prose Writers

- Harsha's works: **Priyadarshika, Nagananda, Ratnavali** (1, 2, 4) 1× 2014
- Wrong pair: **Karpuramanjari-Harsha** 1× 2012
- **Bharavi-Kiratarjuniya, Harsha-Nagananda, Kalidasa-Malavikagnimitra, Rajashekhara-Karpuramanjari** 1× 2006
- **Mudrarakshasa**: **Vishakhadatta** 1× 1992
- Wrong pair: **Subandhu-Kadambari** (Kadambari = Bana) 1× 2006
- **Dashakumaracharita**: **Dandin** 2× 2005, 2008
- **Mattavilasa Prahasana**: **Mahendravarman** (Pallava) 1× 2010
- **Amir Khusrau-Alauddin, Kalidasa-Chandragupta II, Harishena-Samudragupta, Banabhatta-Harsha** 1× 2002
- **Jayadeva** (Gita Govinda) at **Lakshmana Sena's** court 2× 1999, 2010

Work	Author
Mudrarakshasa	Vishakhadatta
Mrichchhakatika	Shudraka
Kadambari, Harshacharita	Banabhatta
Vasavadatta	Subandhu
Dashakumaracharita	Dandin
Kiratarjuniya	Bharavi
Karpuramanjari	Rajashekhara
Gita Govinda	Jayadeva

15.3 History, Stories and Law

- Kalhana's contemporary king: **Jayasimha** (Kashmir) 1× 2010
- Rajatarangini: **eight** tarangas 1× 2015
- Continued by **Jonaraja and Srivara** 1× 2000
- **Trivikrama Bhatta-Nala Champu, Somadeva-Kathasaritsagara, Jayadeva-Gita Govinda, Kshemendra-Brihatkathamanjari** 1× 2025
- **Manusmriti**: mainly the **social system** 1× 2007
- First law-giver: **Manu** 2× 2004, 2008
- **Sarvavarma-Katantra, Shudraka-Mrichchhakatika, Vijnaneshvara-Mitakshara, Kalhana-Rajatarangini** 2× 2002, 2003

QUANTUM IAS & PCS

- **Devana Bhatta-Smriti Chandrika, Hemadri-Chaturvarga Chintamani, Madhavacharya-Parashara Madhaviya, Ballala Sena-Dana Sagara** 1× 2024

15.4 Medicine, Mathematics, Foreign Accounts and Music

- **Charaka Samhita**: **120 chapters, 8 sections** 1× 2023
- **Ashtanga Sangraha-medicine, Dasharupaka-drama, Lilavati-maths, Mahabhashya-grammar** 1× 2002
- **Zero**: invented by **Indians** 1× 2015
- Decimal place value: **Aryabhata** (key) 1× 2014
- Algebra: **Bhaskara** 2× 2002, 2002
- **Lilavati**: **Bhaskaracharya** 1× 2017
- **Panchasiddhantika** (Varahamihira): based on **Greek astronomy** (in part) 1× 2014
- **Milindapanha**: a **Pali** text 1× 1996
- Wrong pair: **Natural History-Ptolemy** (it is **Pliny**) 1× 2015
- "Bible" of North Indian music: **Natyashastra** 1× 2019
- Oldest instrument among options: **veena** 1× 2010
- **Ragamala-Pundarik Vitthal, Rasakaumudi-Srikantha, Ragavibodha-Somanatha, Chaturdandi Prakashika-Venkatamakhi** 1× 2022

Scientist	Work
Aryabhata	Aryabhatiya (499 CE); place value, earth's rotation
Varahamihira	Panchasiddhantika, Brihat Samhita
Brahmagupta	Brahmasphutasiddhanta; rules of zero
Bhaskara II	Lilavati, Bijaganita
Charaka	Charaka Samhita (medicine)
Sushruta	Sushruta Samhita (surgery)

TRAP ALERT

- Harsha wrote three plays; **Harshacharita** is Bana's and **Karpuramanjari** is Rajashekhara's.
- **Katyayana** wrote the Varttika; **Patanjali** the Mahabhashya.
- Kadambari = **Bana**; Vasavadatta = **Subandhu**.
- Natural History = **Pliny**; Geography = **Ptolemy**.

UP LINK

UP link: **Banabhatta** wrote the Harshacharita at Harsha's court in **Kannauj**; **Varanasi** remained the chief seat of Sanskrit learning, and **Ayodhya** and **Naimisharanya** are the settings of epic and Puranic narration.

LAST-MINUTE 10

1. Panini = Ashtadhyayi; Patanjali = Mahabhashya; Yaska = Nirukta
2. Vatsyayana = Kamasutra; Kalhana = Rajatarangini (8 tarangas)
3. Kalidasa = Malavikagnimitra (Agnimitra), Meghaduta
4. Harsha = Priyadarshika, Nagananda, Ratnavali
5. Vishakhadatta = Mudrarakshasa; Dandin = Dashakumaracharita
6. Mahendravarman = Mattavilasa Prahasana
7. Jayadeva = Gita Govinda (Lakshmana Sena)
8. Vijnaneshvara = Mitakshara; Manu = first law-giver
9. Bhaskara = Lilavati, algebra; Aryabhata = place value
10. Natyashastra = bible of music; Pliny = Natural History